



△ CANOPY OF MOSSES

The continually wet conditions of the coastal temperate rain forest provide an ideal habitat for moss. Over 100 varieties can be found draped over the branches of the conifer trees that dominate this environment.

Pacific Northwest Rain Forest

The world's largest undeveloped coastal temperate rain forest, with the greatest amount of wood—living and dead—of any forest on Earth



△ FOREST FERNS

The rich forest floor provides nutrients for many fern species, including lady, deer, and sword ferns.

Coastal temperate rain forests are a very rare forest type. Today, they are believed to cover just 116,700 square miles (302,200 square km)—less than 0.2 percent of Earth's land area. Oceans, mountains, and high rainfall are features of these forests, and the largest intact areas stretch from northern California to Canada and the Gulf of Alaska. The Pacific Northwest measures annual rainfall in feet, and 8–14 ft (2.5–4.2 m) is not unusual. Constantly decaying cedar, Sitka spruce, Douglas fir, and coast redwood needles and deciduous leaves create rich soil that supports hundreds of moss, fern, and invertebrate species, while rivers, lakes, and streams are home to salmon and trout, which in turn attract bears and bald eagles.



▷ WASTE MANAGEMENT

A vital part of the ecosystem, the Pacific banana slug breaks down rotting plants, spreading seeds and spores in the process.

THE WORLD'S COASTAL TEMPERATE RAIN FORESTS

Apart from North America's Pacific Northwest, coastal temperate rain forests occur in southwest South America; the northeastern Atlantic region (including Iceland, Ireland, Scotland, Norway, and northern Spain); the eastern Black Sea; southwest Japan; New Zealand, Tasmania, and Australia's New South Wales; and the tip of South Africa.

